GRADE 4

Curriculum Book

Businesses need a simple plan

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 4 - Curriculum Book

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Hi, I'm Cash. *This is your book. It belongs to you. You'll write in it. You'll cross things out. You'll change your mind. That's all part of it.*

This year, we're going to make a plan. Not a fancy plan. A plan that fits on one page, with real numbers and a real customer. We'll start by reading about a real business. Then we'll check our own ideas with five questions. Then we'll make a budget that doesn't go over fifty dollars. Then we'll write the plan and revise it.

If you don't know an answer, write "*I don't know yet.*" That's a real answer. We'll come back.

Ready? Let's go.

— Cash

Five answers, one page

The whole plan fits on one sheet of paper.

Unit 1 — Read a real business

"A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one."

- CASH, GRADE 4

Activity 1.1 — My Day 1 Idea

Write down one kind of business you're curious about. Just one sentence. You don't have to be sure. We'll come back to it.

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *I'm curious about a ____ **for** ____ who needs _____.*

Now answer two more questions:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *One thing a customer might want from this business: _____*
> *One thing I don't yet know about this business: _____*

On a scale of 1 to 5, how confident are you that this is a good idea?

[ ] 1 — not sure at all [ ] 2 [ ] 3 [ ] 4 [ ] 5 — pretty sure

(We'll check this number again in Week 36. No peeking.)

Activity 1.2 — The Three Questions

Every business profile answers these three questions. When you read about a real business, look for all three.

1. **What does it do?**
2. **Who does it help?**

3. How does it make money?

Read the profile your teacher gives you. Then fill in:

QUESTION	ANSWER (IN YOUR OWN WORDS)
What does it do?	
Who does it help?	
How does it make money?	

Now write a 3 to 5 sentence summary in your own words. Use this frame if you need it:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> ***_ is a business that _****. Their customers are* ***_. They make money by _****. The thing that makes them different is ____.*

Activity 1.3 — My Capstone Topic

You read about a real business. Now you'll start your own — on paper. Across this year, you'll plan one business. We call this your Capstone.

Pick a kind of business that fits one of these:

- Food (snacks, drinks, baked goods — with adult permission)
- Tutoring (a subject you know, for younger students)
- Content (zines, comics, drawings, videos — for a real audience)
- Service (yard work, dog walking, tidying — for neighbors)
- Repair (fixing things, cleaning, small fixes)
- Events (a class party, a craft afternoon, a game day)

Write your Capstone Topic in one sentence:

CASH SAYS

*My Capstone is a _ **for** ____ who need _____.*

This sentence will live on the front page of your journal. You can revise it. You can pivot once in Week 9 or once in Week 19. Cash says: *that's not failing. That's evidence.*

Reflection — End of Unit 1

Three questions. Be honest. 1 to 2 sentences each.

1. What's one thing you didn't know about real businesses before this unit?
2. Why did you pick the Capstone Topic you picked?
3. What's one thing you're already worried about?

Unit 2 — The Reality Check

TRY THIS

One question, five people

Pick the customer question from your one-page plan. Ask five real people in one day. Write each answer in one sentence.

Activity 2.1 — The Five Questions

Cash's question for the year is "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

Here's how we check. Five questions. Real answers, with real numbers.

#	QUESTION	MY ANSWER (WITH A NUMBER WHERE I CAN)
1	**Who buys?** Be specific. Not "kids." Try "third graders who play kickball at recess."	
2	**How much?** What's the price for one customer?	$
3	**How many?** How many customers in a day, week, or month? Pick a real time and a real number.	
4	**What does it cost me?** Per customer, what do I spend on supplies?	$
5	**What's left?** Money in minus money out. (Q2 × Q3 minus Q4 × Q3.)	$

If the answer to Question 5 is small or negative, that's not a problem. That's information. Cash says: "*Math is not your enemy. Math tells you what to fix.*"

Activity 2.2 — The Least Sure

Look at your five answers. Which one are you least sure about?

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *The question I'm least sure about is Question #__ because _____*
> *One way I could check: _____*

(Maybe ask a friend. Maybe count. Maybe look up a price. Cash says: *check what's checkable.*)

Activity 2.3 — The One-Sentence Customer Statement

Now you'll write one sentence about your customer. The format is:

> **CASH SAYS**
> "*This is for [WHO] who needs [WHAT].*"

Write three drafts. Each more specific than the last.

Draft 1 (vague is okay):

> **CASH SAYS**
> *This is for _____*

Draft 2 (more specific):

> **CASH SAYS**
> *This is for _____*

Draft 3 (your best — name an age, a place, a moment, or a habit):

> **CASH SAYS**
> *This is for _____*

Now ask a partner: "*Could you point to a real person who matches this customer?*" If they can't, revise. If they can, you're ready.

Reflection — End of Unit 2

1. Did your Reality Check change your idea? How?
2. What's one number you'd guess differently if you had to do this again?
3. Who's the first real person who would buy what you're selling?

Unit 3 — The $50 Plan

WORDS TO KNOW

Plan
Five honest answers about how a business works.

Customer
The exact person you can name and describe.

Offer
What the customer gets, in plain words.

Pricing
What the customer pays, and why that number.

Test
The smallest real thing you can do to see if the plan works.

Activity 3.1 — Maya's Bake Sale

Read this story:

> CASH SAYS
>
> *Maya is planning a Game Day for her fourth-grade class — 25 students. She has $50 from the school. She wants snacks, decorations, supplies for board games, and small prizes. She makes a list: $20 in snacks, $15 in decorations, $18 in supplies, $10 in prizes. Total: $63. She has $50.*

What does Maya cut?

CUT	WHY

Maya didn't fail. She made a trade-off. That's what budgets are.

Activity 3.2 — Build Your $50 Event Budget

Pick one classroom event:

[ ] Class Game Day (board games, prizes, decorations) [ ] Class Craft Afternoon (paper, markers, glue, small prizes) [ ] Class Read-Aloud Day (cozy decorations, bookmarks, small prizes for trivia)

Now build the budget. You must:

- Have at least 4 categories.
- Stay under $50.
- Show your math (quantity × price = subtotal).

CATEGORY	ITEM	QUANTITY	PRICE	SUBTOTAL
1.			$	$
1.			$	$
2.			$	$
2.			$	$
3.			$	$
3.			$	$
4.			$	$
4.			$	$

Total: $_____ (Cap: $50.)

If your total is over $50, cross out something. Cut. Don't feel bad — that's the work.

Activity 3.3 — The Trade-Off Sentence

Every budget makes you pick. Write your trade-off sentence:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *To stay under $50, I had to _____ **instead of** _____, because _____.*

Activity 3.4 — Three Rules for a Kid-Run Business

Read these four possible rules:

1. **Honesty about ingredients.** If you're selling food, say what's in it. Don't hide allergens.
2. **Safety with food.** Wash hands. Use clean tools. Keep cold things cold.
3. **Asking adult permission.** Get a parent's or teacher's okay before you sell.
4. **Age limits on labor.** Some jobs are not for kids — power tools, hot oil, things that need a license.

Pick three. Write them in your own words:

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS IN MY OWN WORDS
1.	
2.	
3.	

Now pick the most important one:

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *The most important rule is _ **because** _____*

Activity 3.5 — Honest or Sketchy? Sort the scenarios.

SCENARIO	HONEST, SKETCHY, UNSAFE, OR NOT-ALLOWED-YET?	WHY?
A kid sells lemonade made from a powder packet but tells customers it's "fresh-squeezed."		
A kid says they'll refund a broken bracelet, then doesn't.		
A kid sells homemade granola bars without washing hands.		
A 9-year-old advertises a house-cleaning service online without telling parents.		

Reflection — End of Unit 3

1. What was the hardest part of staying under $50?
2. Which of your three rules do you think most kid-run businesses break? Why?
3. What's one thing about budgeting you'll remember next year?

Unit 4 — The One-Page Plan defense

MATH MOMENT

How many a week?

If you sold 3 a day for 5 days, how many is that? If each one costs $2 to make and sells for $5, what's left?

Activity 4.1 — The 5-Minute Team Meeting

Run a 5-minute meeting with your Capstone team (or with a partner if you're solo). Use this agenda. The timer is real.

ITEM	TIME	NOTES
1. **Last week** — what got done?	1 min	
2. **This week** — what's the plan?	2 min	
3. **Blockers** — what's stuck?	2 min	

Roles (rotate every meeting):

- **Facilitator** (runs the agenda): _____
- **Timekeeper** (watches the clock): _____
- **Note-taker** (writes things down): _____

Cash's rule: "*When the timer says move on, you move on. You can come back later.*"

Activity 4.2 — Build Your One-Page Plan (Draft 1)

This is the page that holds your year. Fill in every box with real words and real numbers.

My Capstone is:

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

Customer (one sentence):

> CASH SAYS
>
> *This is for* _____

Price per customer: $__ **Cost per customer: $_** ***What's left per customer: $___***

Three steps to run this business:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

One rule I'll follow:

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

One thing I'm not sure about yet:

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

Activity 4.3 — Mark Your Draft 1

Look at your One-Page Plan above. Use three colors:

- **Yellow** — anything about the customer.
- **Blue** — anything about the math (price, cost, what's left).
- **Pink** — anything about the plan (the three steps, the rule).

Now ask yourself: *what would I change if I could?* Mark the spots that feel weak.

Activity 4.4 — Build Your Draft 2

On a fresh sheet (or your teacher's One-Page Plan template), rewrite your plan. Make at least three changes. At least one customer change AND at least one math change.

Activity 4.5 — Before/After Diff Sheet

Three changes. One reason each.

#	WHAT I CHANGED	CUSTOMER / MATH / PLAN?	WHY I CHANGED IT
1			
2			
3			

Now circle the three changes on Draft 1 and Draft 2 so a reader can see them.

Cash's question: "*Which change do you think mattered most? Why?*"

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> _____

Activity 4.6 — Defense Day Prep

You'll get 4 minutes to defend your One-Page Plan. Practice once with a partner. Use these four sections, one minute each.

1. The customer (1 min):

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *My customer is* ***_. They want _****. Here's the one-sentence statement:* ***_____****.*

2. The math (1 min):

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> *My price is* ***$_. My cost per customer is $_****. What's left is* ***$_. I priced it where I did because _****.*

3. The budget (1 min):

> CASH SAYS
>
> *I budgeted a [event] for $50 with these categories: **_. The trade-off was** _ instead of ____.*

4. The three changes (1 min):

> CASH SAYS
>
> *Between Draft 1 and Draft 2, I changed (1) **_, (2)** _, and (3) **_. The change that mattered most was** _ because ____.*

Activity 4.7 — Year-End Reflection

When your defense is done, come back to this page. Be specific. Be honest.

1. **The biggest thing I learned this year was:**

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

2. **One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 4 student:**

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

3. **I'm proud of:**

> CASH SAYS
>
> _____

4. **I'm going to keep working on:**

CASH SAYS

_____

The Day 1 card

Your teacher will hand back the index card you filled out in Week 1. Compare your "I'm curious about" sentence then with your One-Page Plan now.

CASH SAYS

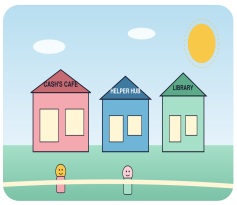
On Day 1, I was curious about ____. Now my Capstone is ____. The biggest difference is ____.

Cash says: "*Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. The work is being a little less wrong, every week.*"

Vocabulary Spine

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real answers

Read each plan answer to a different person. Write what they say back, exactly. That's data.

Keep this page in the back of your journal. Add a one-line definition for each term as you meet it.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS IN MY OWN WORDS	UNIT
business		1
customer		1
product		1
service		1
profile		1
summary		1
idea		2
plan		2
estimate		2
reasonable		2
customer statement		2
problem		2
budget		3
cap		3
category		3
subtotal		3
total		3
cost		3
revenue		3
profit		3

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS IN MY OWN WORDS	UNIT
draft		4
revise		4
change		4
before/after		4
agenda		4
blocker		4
defend		4

Cash's Notebook (asides)

FAMILY TALK

Five honest answers

Read your one-page plan to a family member. Ask: 'Which answer sounds the least real to you, and why?' Listen, don't defend.

Some pages of this book have a small note from Cash. Read them when you get to them.

CASH SAYS

Cash's first aside (Unit 1): *"You don't have to be right on Day 1. You have to be specific. Specific is the start of being right later."*
Cash's second aside (Unit 2): *"A guess with a number is a hundred times better than a guess without one. 'Lots of customers' is not a number. '15 customers on Saturday' is. Try the number."*
Cash's third aside (Unit 3): *"Every budget is a trade-off. You can't have all the things. The work is picking what matters."*
Cash's fourth aside (Unit 4): *"Your plan changing is not a mistake. Your plan not changing is a mistake. A plan that didn't change in nine months means you stopped paying attention."*
Cash's last aside (end of book): *"Plans are just thinking written down. You wrote your thinking down. That's the whole year. Take a breath. You're done."*

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 4)

CASH ASKS

"Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one."

Practice A — Three drafts of the same budget

For an event you'd like to plan (a class party, a school fundraiser, a small market). Build three budgets at three different cap levels:

Cap = $25. Top categories: __ ***Total: Cap = $50.*** *Top categories:* __ ***Total:***
Cap = $100. Top categories: __ ***Total:*** _

What changed at each cap? ____

Practice B — Customer statement, three ways

Pick one of your business ideas. Write the customer statement three times, each for a different customer.

Idea: _____

1. "This is for _ **who needs** _."
2. "This is for _ **who needs** _."
3. "This is for _ **who needs** _."

Which customer would you pick to start with? Why? ____

Practice C — Reality Check for an idea

Run your favorite idea through the 5-question Reality Check.

1. **Who buys? _____**
2. **How much will they pay? _____**
3. **How many will buy? _____**
4. **What does it cost me to make/serve one? _____**
5. **What's left after I cover the cost? _____**

The "what's left" number — would you do this for that number? Why or why not? ____

Practice D — The before/after diff

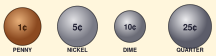
Take any plan from earlier in the year. List 3 things you'd change now, and why.

BEFORE	AFTER	WHY I CHANGED IT

FROM CASH

A plan is five honest answers

Who is it for? What is it? Why now? How much? How will I know it worked? Five lines. One page. Done.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 4 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Income - earning, planning, and tradeoffs.

CEE NS5
Roles of producers, consumers, and decisions.

CCSS-MATH 4.OA
Operations and algebraic thinking - model word problems.

CCSS-ELA W.4.2
Write to inform and explain - one-page plan.

CASEL Responsible Decision-Making
Identify problems, analyze situations.

C3 D2.Eco.2.3-5
Identify positive and negative incentives.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one. — Cash

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